

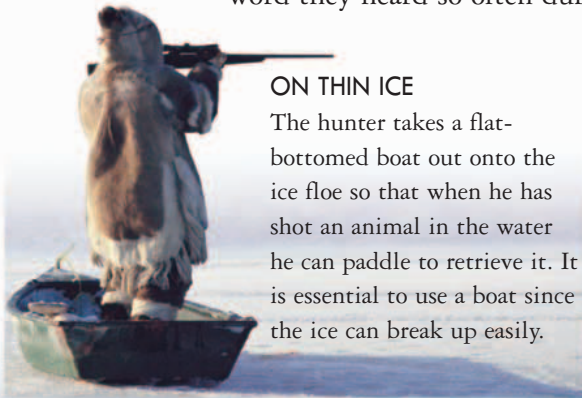


without much outside contact and developed a tough way of life that suited their frozen environment. Since their **integration** into the political structure of Canada, their lives have **modernized** in many aspects.

However, the Inuit make efforts to keep their traditions—old **superstitions** combine with Christianity, dogsleds run alongside **skidoos**, and raw meat is eaten along with prepackaged meals.

The modern hunt

The Inuit still hunt out on the ice for valuable meat and fur, and can be away from home for a month or more. They use snowmobiles or dogsleds, and guns. The hunters talk to each other over radios, known as *uvaa*, which means “over,” named after the word they heard so often during transmissions.



ON THIN ICE

The hunter takes a flat-bottomed boat out onto the ice floe so that when he has shot an animal in the water he can paddle to retrieve it. It is essential to use a boat since the ice can break up easily.

An igloo may keep out some cold, but in temperatures of -40°F (-40°C), the inside will still be a chilly -14°F (-10°C).

LIFE ON THE LAND

It is a difficult and not very prosperous life as a full-time hunter. However, there are some families who have returned to the land to live in camps all year round. The Canadian Government now helps financially in an effort to try to regain some of the Inuit traditions.

